

THE THREE STAGES OF MENOPAUSE

-Perimenopause, Menopause, and Postmenopause

Welcome! This guide explains the three stages of menopause -perimenopause, menopause, and postmenopause. These natural life stages involve hormonal changes that can affect the body in different ways. Understanding them can help you recognize symptoms and take steps to support your health. ✨

Perimenopause: The Transition Phase 🌸

- **Definition:** The transitional time leading up to menopause when the ovaries begin producing less estrogen. 🌿
- **Timing:** Perimenopause usually begins in the mid-40s but may start as early as the late 30s. It can last several months to several years, with an average duration of about four years. ⌚
- **Biological Changes:** Estrogen levels fluctuate unpredictably, ovulation becomes irregular and cycles may shorten or lengthen. ❤️

Common Symptoms:

- Irregular periods
- Hot flashes
- Sleep disturbances
- Night sweats
- Mood swings
- Breast tenderness
- Vaginal dryness

Menopause: The Milestone 🌺

- **Definition:** Menopause is defined as the point when a person has gone 12 consecutive months without a menstrual period. It marks the end of the reproductive years and the transition from perimenopause to postmenopause.
- **Typical Age:** Menopause most commonly occurs between ages 45 and 55, with the average age being around 51.

- **Biological Changes:** During menopause, the ovaries stop releasing eggs and produce much lower levels of the hormones estrogen and progesterone. As a result, menstrual cycles permanently stop. 🌞

Common Symptoms:

- Hot flashes
- Night sweats
- Irregular or skipped periods leading up to the final period
- Sleep difficulties
- Mood changes or irritability
- Vaginal dryness
- Decreased energy or fatigue

Postmenopause: The Long-Term Stage 🌸

- **Definition:** The years following menopause.
- **Biological Changes:** Hormone levels remain low and stable.

Symptoms:

- Hot flashes may continue for some people
- Vaginal dryness
- Sleep changes
- Reduced bone density

Long-Term Health Considerations:

Lower estrogen levels increase risk for:

- **Osteoporosis:** Decreased estrogen can lead to bone loss. Regular exercise and calcium intake are crucial. 🦴
- **Cardiovascular Disease:** Estrogen plays a protective role for the heart. Manage risk factors like blood pressure and cholesterol. ❤️

Estrogen plays a protective role in:

- Bone density maintenance
- Cholesterol regulation
- Vascular health

After menopause, monitoring and preventive care become important

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

Educational content informed by peer-reviewed clinical research published in the Journal of Clinical Endocrinology & Metabolism and JAMA, as well as clinical guidance from the American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists (ACOG), the U.S. Office on Women's Health, the World Health Organization (WHO), and the Cleveland Clinic.

